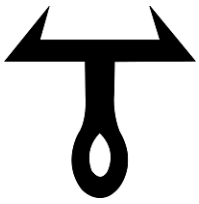
Ideas for Homebrewed Dark Eras



malonkey1
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 1620

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11-02-2017, 12:41 PM #76

*Originally posted by **The Kings Raven***
I'd really like to see Genius set in Europe between WW1 and WW2. One of Genius' themes is how human intellectualism can go horribly wrong, and the interwar period has that in spades.

You have the very idea of "the war to end all wars" that caused a generation to go to war and die. You have the declining ideals of empire. And young powerful ideas, fascism and communism, promise a shineing new future born in blood.

Players will be brilliant people, scarred by WW1 (weather they fought in the front lines or not) who realised the ideals they fought for were hollow and flawed and must struggle to accept this. Some will find closure, and others, they will learn nothing and they will burn the world with the light of their Inspiration.

Yeah, the inter-war period will have been kind of the biggest blow that the Peerage suffers in 2E. The Lemurian/Peerage conflict seriously flared up around WWI, and when everything settled, people were pretty disillusioned with the whole deal after seeing the carnage. Well, most of them were.

Genius: the Transgression 2E is a thing that's being worked on.

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11-02-2017, 01:51 PM #77



The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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*Originally posted by **No One of Consequence***

Mummy Vice? I guess the high concept would be Crocket and Tubbs vs Scarface as seen through the lens of M:tC?

It occurs to me that Miami Vice debuted in 1984, and that, in addition to the obvious Orwell connection, a lot of pop culture and political stuff from that year would seem to make it an ideal year for just about every CoD game line in some way or another. Besides Miami Vice, it's the same year of the V miniseries, the debut of Highway to Heaven, Lifestyles of the Rich & the Famous, Tales from the Darkside, The Cosby Show, and Night Court, along with continuing series like Cagney & Lacey, Hill Street Blues, The A-Team, Magnum PI, Knight Rider, Cheers, Dallas, Falcon Crest and Dynasty.
Film wise, it's the year of Ghostbusters, A Nightmare on Elm Street, The Terminator, Streets of Fire, Sixteen Candles, Purple Rain, Night of the Comet, Moscow on the Hudson, The Never-ending Story, The Karate Kid, The Last Starfighter, Gremlins, Friday the 13th: The Final Chapter (pt 4), Footloose, Firestarter, Children of the Corn, The Adventures of Buckaroo Banzai, Beverly Hills Cop, Breakin', CHUD, The Company of Wolves, Red Dawn, Indiana Jones & The Temple of Doom, Dune, Dreamscape, The Natural, Once Upon a Time in America, Repo Man, and 1984.
In the world of books, it's the year of William Gibson's Neuromancer, Stephen King's The Talisman (with Peter Straub) and Thinner (as Richard Bachman), John Updike's The Witches of Eastwick, Bob Shea & Robert Willson's Illuminatus trilogy, the first of Clive Barker's Books of Blood collections, and Tom Clancy's The Hunt for Red October.
Comics-wise, it's the year Alan Moore started writing Swamp Thing.
Elsewhere, there's the US presidential election (including the first major party ticket to include a woman), the Summer Olympics in LA and the Winter Olympics in Sarajevo, the breakup of the US Bell telephone monopoly, UK coal miner strikes, the Brighton Hotel bombing,and the agreement to eventually turn Hong Kong over the China.

Personally I see it like this

Vampire = already been done with new wave requiem

Werewolf/Geist = Miami Vice/war on drugs

Mage = early cyberpunk

Hunter = golden age of slashers

changeling = Last decade of apartheid

Mummy = Soviet Afghan War

Beast= Satanic Panic

Demon = Year of the Spy/1984

Deviant = ?

Despite the user name I am actually bigender.

My Savannah Setting for CofD can be found here

My heroes as monster tamers rules for BtP can be found here

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No One of Consequence
Member

Join Date: Jan 2017
Posts: 3937

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11-03-2017, 05:22 PM #78

Hmm.

1984: Cocaine Cowboys (Miami and the drug wars)
1984: Hell is for Children (Satanic Panic)
1984: Blood of the Land (South Africa)
1984: City of Ruins (Beirut)
1984: All Teenagers Must Die (Slashers)
1984: Concrete & Crome (LA proto-cyberpunk)

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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11-03-2017, 06:27 PM #79

> *Originally posted by* ***No One of Consequence***
> *Hmm.*
>
> ***1984: Cocaine Cowboys*** *(Miami and the drug wars)*
> ***1984: Hell is for Children*** *(Satanic Panic)*
> ***1984: Blood of the Land*** *(South Africa)*
> ***1984: City of Ruins*** *(Beirut)*
> ***1984: All Teenagers Must Die*** *(Slashers)*
> ***1984: Concrete & Crome*** *(LA proto-cyberpunk)*

I love those titles. I was going to call the satanic panic era "Read Me Backwards" but your title is much better.

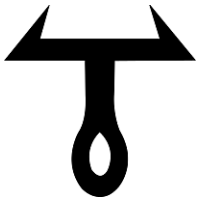
Despite the user name I am actually bigender.

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malonkey1
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 1620

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11-04-2017, 12:12 PM #80

So if the Satanic Panic era were to happen, would we get rules for playing D&D within ChroD?

Genius: the Transgression 2E is a thing that's being worked on.

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The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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11-04-2017, 01:24 PM #81

> *Originally posted by* ***malonkey1***
> *So if the Satanic Panic era were to happen, would we get rules for playing D&D within ChroD?*

Be sure to check out the Pulling Report for a taste of how the anti-rpg part of the panic went. Patricia Pulling is a good example of the phony occult crimes investigators that offered their services to prosecutors in various trials related to the panic, in addition to her anti-rpg hysteria. Said phony occult investigators would be a great role for a Hero.

Last edited by The young man in the cafe; 11-04-2017, 01:37 PM.

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My Savannah Setting for CofD can be found here

My heroes as monster tamers rules for BtP can be found here

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11-04-2017, 02:59 PM #82

> *Originally posted by* ***The young man in the cafe***
>
> *I love those titles. I was going to call the satanic panic era "Read Me Backwards" but your title is much better.*

No One of Consequence
Member

Join Date: Jan 2017
Posts: 3937

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It's a Pat Benatar song off her 1980 album Crimes of Passion, and one of the few top 40 songs dealing with the subject of child abuse, so it fits in two ways.

I'm trying to think of something suitable for Japan during that year, with the PM Nakasone Era economic bubble, maybe at the intersection between business, politics and organized crime. That or the rebellious aspects of youth culture during the period.

Also something for Britain in that year. maybe against the backdrop of the miners' strike, compounded by the various industrial accidents (Abbeystead, Oxford Circus, the numerous railways accidents) and terrorist bombings (Heathrow, Brighton) and the long running investigations into police corruption. For some reason it seems to scream for a Promethean angle.

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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11-04-2017, 03:48 PM #83

> *Originally posted by* ***No One of Consequence***
>
> *It's a Pat Benatar song off her 1980 album Crimes of Passion, and one of the few top 40 songs dealing with the subject of child abuse, so it fits in two ways.*
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For Japan, *A Monster with 21 Faces* could be the title, after the mysterious terrorists behind the *Glico Morinaga case* which happens to be the most infamous unsolved crime in Japanese history, perfect for a cabal of magi to solve. The whole incident sounds like something out of a cyberpunk novel anyway.

Also, keep in mind, our angle with the satanic panic dark era is that the Satanic ritual abuse never actually happened, it was a moral panic meant to hide the activities of the real satanists on wall street and in the mega churches. Basically making the greed is good part of the 80s much more sinister.

The era is sort of meant to be a beast and inferno crossover.

Have you seen the list of books on the panic I recommended?

Last edited by The young man in the cafe; 11-04-2017, 03:59 PM.

Despite the user name I am actually bigender.

My Savannah Setting for CofD can be found here

My heroes as monster tamers rules for BtP can be found here

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No One of Consequence
Member

Join Date: Jan 2017
Posts: 3937

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11-05-2017, 09:35 AM #84

Well, I figured in this case the child abuse would be at the hands of overzealous law enforcement, therapists and district attorneys (Heroes?) who effectively browbeat the kids into making accusations and convinced them that they'd been abused, screwing up the lives of everyone involved with the justification that they're doing heroic work against evil.

(About 20 years ago, DC comics had an imprint called Paradox Press that put out a number of graphic novels, one of which, Green Candles, involved the problems with "recovered" memories and a case of ritual satanic abuse. Kind of surprised it was never made into a film the way A History of Violence and Road to Perdition were, as I thought it would've made for a pretty effective psychological mystery thriller.)

I'm trying to work out some sort of Geist/Compact-level Hunter concept about ghosts and hauntings, inspired by the likes of Ghostbusters, A Nightmare on Elm Street, Christine, The Dead Zone, Poltergeist, Ghost Story, and maybe Evil Dead.

Also, I keep wondering if there's something for Changing Breeds in this somewhere.

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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Flyboy254
Member

11-05-2017, 10:21 AM #85

Can we expand the 1920s-1930s as well to some other splats? Hunter is full of two-fisted tales for storytelling back in that era, and Changeling could easily focus on the rising subcultures of the time.

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Posts: 703

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The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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11-05-2017, 12:34 PM #86

*Originally posted by **No One of Consequence***

Well, I figured in this case the child abuse would be at the hands of overzealous law enforcement, therapists and district attorneys (Heroes?) who effectively browbeat the kids into making accusations and convinced them that they'd been abused, screwing up the lives of everyone involved with the justification that they're doing heroic work against evil.

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I'm trying to work out some sort of Geist/Compact-level Hunter concept about ghosts and hauntings, inspired by the likes of Ghostbusters, A Nightmare on Elm Street, Christine, The Dead Zone, Poltergeist, Ghost Story, and maybe Evil Dead.

Also, I keep wondering if there's something for Changing Breeds in this somewhere.

That is exactly what I was thinking.

Despite the user name I am actually bigender.

My Savannah Setting for CofD can be found here

My heroes as monster tamers rules for BtP can be found here

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No One of Consequence
Member

11-05-2017, 05:15 PM #87

1984: The Haunted Valley, (working title) set in the San Fernando Valley and it's LA commuter towns (the world you see in Fast Times at Ridgemont High, Valley Girl, ET, and The Karate Kid) and/or Orange Valley (Poltergeist), based around the idea that back in the 1920s, an architect built a building in LA designed to harness spiritual energy from the underworld, perhaps with the idea of summoning some ancient god. Because of certain astrological alignments, that building has become active and is causing a massive upswing in hauntings and other paranormal disturbances in the region. The PCs are from these surrounding small towns (ideally teens and 20somethings) forced to deal with

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Posts: 3937

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things like their suburb being haunted by bodies that weren't moved from the graveyard the new neighborhood was built on, the ghost of a dead serial killer coming back for revenge on the children of the vigilante mob that killed him, weird government investigators and the like. This eventually leads them to the corrupt book of ancient lore used by the architect and his building. Maybe primarily for Geist and Hunter, and perhaps Second Sight. It may also fit with Mummy, but I'm not familiar enough with that game to say for sure.

Last edited by No One of Consequence; 11-05-2017, 05:27 PM.

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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Vent0
Member

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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11-05-2017, 05:33 PM #88

Originally posted by ***No One of Consequence***

1984: The Haunted Valley*, (working title) set in the San Fernando Valley and it's LA commuter towns (the world you see in Fast Times at Ridgemont High, Valley Girl, ET, and The Karate Kid) and/or Orange Valley (Poltergeist), based around the idea that back in the 1920s, an architect built a building in LA designed to harness spiritual energy from the underworld, perhaps with the idea of summoning some ancient god. Because of certain astrological alignments, that building has become active and is causing a massive upswing in hauntings and other paranormal disturbances in the region. The PCs are from these surrounding small towns (ideally teens and 20somethings) forced to deal with things like their suburb being haunted by bodies that weren't moved from the graveyard the new neighborhood was built on, the ghost of a dead serial killer coming back for revenge on the children of the vigilante mob that killed him, weird government investigators and the like. This eventually leads them to the corrupt book of ancient lore used by the architect and his building. Maybe primarily for Geist and Hunter, and perhaps Second Sight. It may also fit with Mummy, but I'm not familiar enough with that game to say for sure.*

Well the architect could *be* a Tef-Aabhi mummy. As for why they designed it? Who knows - maybe even the mummy themselves forgot. Either way, it could trigger every Arisen in the area waking towards some purpose (to include Mummies, regardless of who the architect and their plan is).

The whole thing also sounds like an Occult Matrix, if you wanted Demon or general God-Machine involvement.

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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No One of Consequence
Member

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11-06-2017, 04:18 PM #89

(Very rough concept)
1984: Diamond Dogs, taking it's name from David Bowie's 1974 album (which apparently started as an effort to turn Orwell's 1984 into a stage musical), set in London, among the youth culture of the Blitz Kids/New Romantics and the city's gay population, with the period's socio-economic upheavals and the beginnings of the AIDs crisis perpetually lurking around the edges of everything. I'm thinking this might be primarily a Changeling: The Lost setting, with possible Promethean and Vampire angles as add-ons, something with a lot of the overtones and themes you see in the world of people like Clive Barker, Neil Gaiman, Grant Morrison and the like. Themes of alienation from "respectable" mainstream society and wanting to make one's own mark on the world, with a lot of urban dark fantasy elements mixed in.

And, as a possible title for a Japanese/Tokyo cyberpunk setting (probably focused on Mage), **1984: Burst City**, which is the name of this somewhat weird Japanese dystopian punk rock musical action movie from the early 80s.

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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No One of Consequence
Member

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11-06-2017, 04:39 PM #90

> *Originally posted by **Flyboy254***
> *Can we expand the 1920s-1930s as well to some other splats? Hunter is full of two-fisted tales for storytelling back in that era, and Changeling could easily focus on the rising subcultures of the time.*

Dark Eras: Roaring 20s

- The Beautiful & The Damned (Vampire in the vein of F. Scott Fitzgerald)
- The Lost Generation (Changeling in Paris among the expatriates)
- The Waste Land (Promethean in the after math of the Great War)
- Metropolis (Mage and maybe Demon in New York City working in the themes of the Fritz Lang film)
- Shadows Out of Time (Mummy and Hunter dealing with ancient eldritch horrors as envisioned by Lovecraft)
- Hard Liquor (Beast in the age of Prohibition)

And maybe something with Werewolf dealing with the rise of the KKK in the midwest.

What is tolerance? It is the consequence of humanity. We are all formed of frailty and error; let us pardon reciprocally each other's folly. That is the first law of nature.
Voltaire, "Tolerance" (1764)

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